

According to the World Mineral Production Data 2018-22, in the year 2022, Kazakhstan is the largest producer of Uranium.

9. Which of the following is not among the major resources of Russia?

- (a) Coal
- (b) Iron-ore
- (c) Diamonds
- (d) Uranium

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (d)

When the question was asked option (d) was correct answer. Russia possesses rich reserves of iron ore, manganese, chromium, nickel, platinum, titanium, copper, tin, lead, tungsten, diamonds phosphates and gold. However, according to the World Mineral Production data of 2018-22, Russia has 6th position of Uranium production in 2022.

Mineral: Miscellaneous

*The Bauxite reserves of the world are estimated to be around 29.00 million tonnes. *According to the figures of USGS Mineral Commodity Summaries, 2025, the leading countries in terms of bauxite reserves are – (1) **Guinea**, (2) **Australia**, (3) **Vietnam**, (4) **Indonesia** and (5) **Brazil**. According to World Mineral Production 2018-22 (Data-2022), Guinea is the top producer of **Bauxite** in the world, accounting for almost 25.78% of the total global production. **Guinea** is followed by **Australia** and **China** respectively. In this above context, India ranks 6th. *Around 80% of the global tin is extracted from placer deposits. These deposits are found in riverbeds and valleys or on the sea floor. Most of the placer deposits are spread across southeast Asia. The ore of tin is known as **Cassiterite** (Indian Minerals Year Book 2022, Data 2021). The largest producer of tin is China, followed by **Indonesia**, **Myanmar**, and **Peru**. *Diamond is extracted from three different ores. These are **Kimberlite pipes**, **conglomerate** and **Alluvial Gravel**. *According to USGS Mineral Commodity Summaries, 2025 the top three leading countries in terms of diamond (industrial) reserves are– (1) **Russia**, (2) **Botswana** and (3) **D.R. Congo**. According to World Mineral Production 2018-22 (Data - 2022). According to Indian Mineral Yearbook 2022 data, the top five leading producers of diamonds in the world (2021) are – (1) **Russia** (39116970 carats), (2) **Botswana** (22696000 carats), (3) **Canada** (17353418 carats), (4) **Democratic Republic of Congo** (12773000 carats) and (5) **South Africa** (9723811 carats). ***Titanium** is a strong and light metal. It is used in **aerospace industries** and as an alternative to steel. *According to the figures of mineral commodity, 2025 data, in 2024, the largest producer of Titanium is **China**. *Nitrate in the natural form is found in abundance in **Chile** and **Peru**. *Shora is also known as **saltpetre** or **potassium nitrate**. *The largest producer of

nitrate is Chile.

*Rare earth metals is a group of 17 such chemical elements that are important for many advanced industrial productions and developments. The products include - mobile phones, wind turbines, electric car batteries, missiles etc. According to USGS Mineral Commodity Summaries 2025 (data 2024) *On global scale **China** ranks first in the production of **rare earth metals**, accounting about 70% of the total global production. The production of these metals is not only complex but also harmful to the environment. Since the metals can easily be imported from, China hence a lot of countries have stopped production in their own lands. After years of exploitation of this resource, finally, in 2010, China declared to cut back on the production as well as the export of the rare soil metals. *According to Mineral Commodity Summaries 2025, India approximately has 6900000 thousand tonnes of reserves regarding Rare earths. In India, it is found in the states of Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Kerala, Odisha, Tamil Nadu and West Bengal etc.. *Commercial sources of energy includes– Renewable energy, Coal, Oil and Gas, Hydroelectricity and Uranium. The recent discovery of Lithium in Afghanistan has been compared with the discovery of oil in Iran. *Camphor is an Organic liquid which is sublime in nature. It is extracted from three resources – (1) It is extracted from the woods of the camphor laurel (*Cinnamomum camphora*) tree. (2) Bheemseni kapur is found occurring in natural form in Sumatra and Borneo. It is extracted from the *Dryobalanops Aromatica* tree which belongs to *Dipterocarpaceae* family. (3) **Patri Kapoor** is extracted in India. It is extracted from the plants belonging to *Blumea* species of *Compositae* family.

*Non-ferrous metals are those metals or alloys, which does not have any amount of iron in them. The important non-ferrous metals are – Aluminium, Copper, Lead, Nickel, Tin, Titanium, Zinc, Silver, Gold, Platinum, Cobalt, Mercury, Tungsten, Beryllium, Strontium, Cadmium, Gallium, Germanium, Zirconium etc.

***Port Radium** is located in Canada which is world famous for uranium reserves. In USA copper is produced in Bingham Canyon an area of Utah.

***Baku** is located in Azerbaijan, on the Northern slopes of Caucasus Mountains, Baku is world famous for petroleum.

*The **Mesabi Range** of North America is located near Lake Superior and contain reserves of Iron ore. The other five important ranges of the region are – Menominee range, Marquette Cuyuna, Vermillion and Gogebic.

*The **Karaganda basin** of Kazakhstan and **Donbas** basin of Ukraine are world famous for the production of coal.

1. Consider the following statements :

1. The Global Ocean Commission grants licences for seabed exploration and mining in international waters.

2. India has received licences for seabed mineral exploration in international waters.
3. 'Rare earth minerals' are present on seafloor in international waters.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

The ocean-level exploration and mining license in international water is granted by the United Nations' International Seabed Authority. In the year 2014, this organization had given license to public and private companies of countries like India, Brazil, Singapore etc. Rare earth minerals are present on seafloor in international waters. Hence statements 2 and 3 are true.

2. Postmasburg and its adjacent areas of South Africa is major producer of which of the following minerals?

- (a) Uranium (b) Bauxite
(c) Manganese (d) Mica

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

Postmasburg and its adjacent areas of South Africa are major producers of manganese.

3. Natural camphor is obtained from –
- (a) high altitude rocks of Himalayan mountains
(b) foams of Angel Falls in Venezuela
(c) a tree native to China and Japan
(d) sediments of tides of the sea near Andaman

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

Natural Camphor is obtained from various sources :
(i) Cinnamomum camphora is the native tree to China and Japan through which camphor is obtained.
(2) Blumea Species of compositae origin camphor is found in India.
(3) Borneo, Sumatra camphor is obtained from Dryobalanops origin.

4. Which group of minerals represents non-ferrous metals?

- (a) Nickel, Zinc, Copper, Aluminium
(b) Nickel, Aluminium, Iron ore, Zinc
(c) Copper, Pig iron, Nickel, Steel
(d) Nickel, Carbon Steel, Aluminium, Zinc

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Re. Exam) (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

Non-Ferrous metals are those minerals which have negligible iron content. Non-ferrous metals are Aluminium, Copper, Zinc, Tin, Titanium, Lead, Nickel etc. In addition to these, some other non-ferrous metals are Gold, Silver, Cobalt, Gallium, Beryllium, Cerium, Tungsten, Mercury, Platinum, Zirconium, Cadmium, Germanium.

5. Match the List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List-I (Minerals)	List-II (Producing Region)
A. Coal	1. Highveld
B. Gold	2. Karaganda Basin
C. Iron Ore	3. San Joaquin Valley
D. Mineral Oil	4. Krivoi Rog

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	3	1	4
(b)	2	1	4	3
(c)	3	2	4	1
(d)	4	1	2	3

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (b)

The correct match of given lists is as follows :

(Minerals)	(Producing Region)
Coal	- Karaganda Basin
Gold	- Highveld
Iron Ore	- Krivoi Rog
Mineral Oil	- San Joaquin Valley

6. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists.

List-I (Minerals)	List- II (Major producer)
A. Mineral Oil	1. Zambia
B. Copper	2. Guyana
C. Manganese	3. Venezuela
D. Bauxite	4. Gabon

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	1	4	2
(b)	3	1	2	4
(c)	1	3	2	4
(d)	1	3	4	2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

The correct match is as follows :

(Mineral)	(Major producer)
Minerals Oil	- Venezuela
Copper	- Zambia
Manganese	- Gabon
Bauxite	- Guyana

Hence (a) is the correct answer.

7. Which one of the following is not correctly matched ?

- | | | |
|------------------|---|-----------|
| (a) Donbas Basin | - | Coal |
| (b) Mesabi Range | - | Copper |
| (c) Mosul | - | Petroleum |
| (d) Transvaal | - | Gold |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (b)

The correct match is as follows :

(Region)	(Minerals)
Donbas Basin	- Coal
Mesabi Range	- Iron ore
Mosul	- Mineral oil
Transvaal	- Gold

Note : Mesabi Range is known for iron ore. All others are correctly matched.

8. Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the codes given below:

List-I	List-II
A. Iron ore	1. Port Radium
B. Petroleum	2. Bingham
C. Copper	3. Baku
D. Uranium	4. Mesabi

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	4	3	2	1
(b)	3	4	1	2
(c)	1	2	3	4
(d)	1	3	2	1

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

Port Radium is located on the east shore of Great Bear Lake, Canada. It is famous worldwide for its uranium reserves. Bingham Canyon Mine is famous for Copper production located southwest of Salt Lake City Utah, U.S.A. Baku in Azerbaijan is the largest city and capital of Azerbaijan, famous for petroleum production. Mesabi Range is one of the important series for Iron ore reserves in the region of Superior Lake, USA.

9. What is Baku famous for ?

- | | |
|----------------------------|-----------------------|
| (a) Iron Industry | (b) Aircraft Industry |
| (c) Ship-building Industry | (d) Petroleum |

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

10. 'Mesabi Range' at international level is known for producing –

- | | | | |
|------------|----------|--------------|-------------|
| (a) Copper | (b) Gold | (c) Iron ore | (d) Uranium |
|------------|----------|--------------|-------------|

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

11. Which one of the following pair is correctly matched:

Mineral	Producer
(a) Copper	Arizona
(b) Coal	Karatzas
(c) Iron ore	Rasatnoora
(d) Petroleum	Donbas

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (a)

Copper is found in Arizona, USA. Rest of the pairs are not correctly matched.

12. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched ?

- | | | |
|-------------------|---|----------|
| (a) Kimberley | - | Diamond |
| (b) Witwatersrand | - | Gold |
| (c) Katanga | - | Copper |
| (d) Saar | - | Iron Ore |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (d)

The correct match of minerals and their producers is as follows:

(Region)	(Mineral)
Kimberley	- Diamond
Witwatersrand	- Gold
Katanga	- Copper
Saar	- Coal
Butte	- Silver

13. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists :

List-I	List-II
(Minerals)	(Important centres)
A. Copper	1. Butte
B. Diamond	2. Katanga
C. Gold	3. Kimberley
D. Silver	4. Witwatersrand

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	4	3	1
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	1	3	2	4
(d)	3	1	4	2

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

14. Recently, according to a news mineral reserves worth \$1 trillion are found in Afghanistan. Mark that mineral which is compared with discovery of oil field in Iran?

- | | |
|------------|-------------|
| (a) Gold | (b) Lithium |
| (c) Cobalt | (d) Iron |

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl.) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The discovery of Lithium mineral in Afghanistan was compared with the discovery of the oil field in Iran.

15. The leading producer of Titanium in the world is
(a) India (b) Japan (c) Russia (d) U.S.A.
U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (c)

When the question was asked, Russia was the leading producer of Titanium in the world. At present, according to the figures of USGS Mineral Commodity Summaries, 2025 (2024 data) China is the leading producer of Titanium mineral concentrates.

16. The biggest producer of Bauxite in the world is –
(a) Australia (b) Brazil
(c) China (d) India
U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

According to the data of Indian Mineral Year Book-2012 Australia is the leading producer of Bauxite. According to Mineral Commodity Summaries 2025 (data, 2024) Guinea is the major producer of Bauxite.

17. Which one of the following countries is the largest producer of Bauxite?
(a) Guinea (b) Australia (c) India (d) Jamaica
U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

18. The mineral which has earned fame to Chile is
(a) Gold (b) Manganese
(c) Nitrate (d) Mineral oil
R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

Nitrate, in its natural form, is found at a wider scale in Chile and Peru. Atacama Desert located in North Chile and South Peru has the largest source of nitrate.

19. Which one of the following is not correctly matched?
(a) Bolivia - Tin
(b) Brazil - Iron ore
(c) Mexico - Silver
(d) Peru - Nitrate
U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2013
U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (*)

According to the Indian Minerals Year Book, 2022 (data 2021), Bolivia ranks 5th in the production of tin. According to USGS, Mineral Commodity Summaries, 2025 (data 2024). Brazilian iron ore (iron content) is at second place in terms of reserves and production. Mexico has a leading position in silver production. In addition, Peru occupy a major Nitrate and Nitre production.

20. Which one of the following is not correctly matched?
(a) Bolivia - Tin
(b) Brazil - Iron ore
(c) Mexico - Silver
(d) Peru - Nitre
U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl.) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (*)

All the options are correctly matched.

21. Recently, there has been a concern over the short supply of a group of elements called 'rare earth metals'. Why?
1. China, which is the largest producer of these elements, has imposed some restrictions on their export.
2. Other than China, Australia, Canada and Chile, these elements are not found in any country.
3. Rare earth metals are essential for the manufacture of various kinds of electronic items and there is a growing demand for these elements.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

Rare earth metals are a group of 17 chemical elements found in the earth's crust that are vital to many modern technologies including consumer electronics, computers, networks, communications, clean energy, etc. All of the world's heavy rare earth comes from Chinese rare earth sources. In 2010, China produced over 95% of the world's rare earth metals supply (According to USGS, Mineral Commodity Summaries, 2025 (data 2024) China produced about 70% rare earths). China has announced regulations on exports and a crackdown on smuggling. Since these metals were easily available from China and their production causes serious trouble to environment. Therefore, most of the countries stopped their production. According to Indian Minerals Year Book 2022, India have 6900000 thousands tonnes reserves of rare earth metals. Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.

22. Which of the following countries is the largest producer of diamond?
(a) Australia (b) Venezuela
(c) Russia (d) Botswana
U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2012
U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)